

ZenitPCB: Handy Tools For Creating Netlist And PCB Layouts

For professional electronic circuit designers and even DIYers who want to test their design before physically animating it, ZenitPCB can be a great tool. This Windows-compatible PCB design suite allows designs with up to 1000 pins.

The complete ZenitPCB suite consists of multiple tools. ZenitPCB Layout tool lets you design the main layout of the printed circuit board by using a netlist of components to be used. ZenitCapture Schematic tool allows you to choose components of the circuit and create a netlist. ZenitPCB tools are contained in a library called ZenitPCB Parts. The software can also read Gerber files through its PCB GerberView tool.

The user interface of ZenitPCB is compact—even with numerous application buttons and quick keys. It contains the main workspace in the middle. Below the menu bar, on the top, there are multiple quick-access keys that allow you to add circuit parts, save a file, print, search and so on. The left panel consists of project-related information including available projects, parts library and available netlists. To the right of the workspace there are shortcuts for different operations like drawing a line, square or circle in the schematic, adding text and so on. The workspace allows simple drag-and-drop operation, so handling the tool is simple.

To start a new project, go to File on the top menu bar and click New. This will open a workspace on the ZenitCapture Schematic tool. The workspace is a sheet in black with green borders giving the position of elements to be placed. Now, you can select components and create your

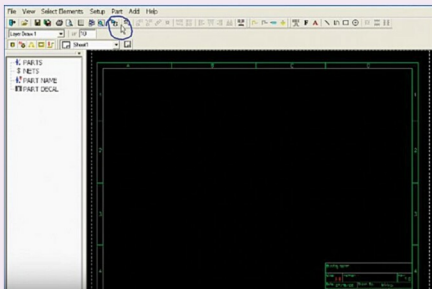


Fig. 1: A blank workspace on the ZenitCapture Schematic tool and the component quick-access button

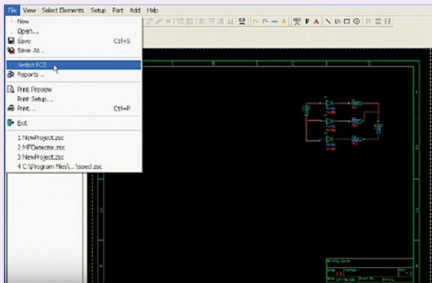


Fig. 2: Saving the netlist

circuit schematic. Components can also be selected from the quick-access button below the top menu bar.

First, click the desired element and then click on the workspace to position it. As soon as you add your first component, you will see a '+' sign

appearing beside Parts option in the left panel. This indicates component addition to your circuit and netlist creation. You can expand this option to check out all the elements added. Elements can be connected by simply dragging (through the mouse) the con-